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Why Everyone Is Switching To OPEN SOURCE



Open source makes tasks easier for businesses and customers alike.

While open source may be just another tech jargon to you, it has transformed operations for many organisations in the past and can intrinsically bring an all-new experience for your company, too. But what is great about open source for your business? Essentially, it is the ease that brings open source to the mainstream, as it makes tasks easier for consumers.

Technology giants like Google and Microsoft, network operators such as Bharti Airtel and Vodafone, and social networking sites like Facebook and Google+, all are using open source to grow in the market.

Unified, profitable model

The original model revolved around open source software alone. But nowadays, hardware and even the cloud have started going the open source way. "It is easier to deploy open source technologies than proprietary ones as these are meant for specific use-cases," said Anant Kumar, head of product engineering and IT, Bharti Airtel.

Airtel is widely adopting open source developments to expand its position in the Indian telecom sector. Whether it is customer acquisition or optimising the experience for its own call centre agents, the Gurugram-headquartered telco is leveraging open source at all major levels.

"Open source has helped us build elastic, scalable systems at low cost and hence increase our productivity," said Harmeen Mehta, global chief information officer, Bharti Airtel. At present, Airtel entirely depends upon open source for its six important projects and has a team of more than 80 engineers to continually monitor and improve its developments.

Substitutes for proprietary solutions

One of the most obvious advantages of open source is its availability as an alternative to proprietary solutions. If you want to switch from Microsoft Office to an open source solution, you can find not just one or two but plenty of substitutes. There are LibreOffice, Apache OpenOffice and KOffice to give you the closest experience to Microsoft Office at no cost.

Likewise, if you are looking to abandon your existing proprietary